

CSV Data Migration — Overview

This playbook covers the complete process for migrating issues into Jira via CSV import. It includes file format requirements, field mapping guidelines, validation steps, and common error resolutions.

Phase 1 — CSV File Preparation

The source CSV must conform to the following structure before import:

Requirement	Specification	Status
File format	.csv (UTF-8 encoded)	Required
File size	Less than 10 MB	Required
Max columns	Up to 4,000 columns	Required
Header row	First row = column names	Required
Date format	YYYY-MM-DD or DD/MM/YYYY	Required
Attachments	JPG or PNG, max 10MB each	Optional
Issue type	Must match Jira issue types	Required
Priority values	Highest/High/Medium/Low/Lowest	Required
Assignee	Jira username or email	Optional

Phase 2 — Field Mapping

Map each CSV column to the corresponding Jira field:

CSV Column Header	Maps to Jira Field	Field Type	Notes
Summary	Summary	Text	Required — max 255 chars
Issue Type	Issue Type	Select	Story / Bug / Task / Epic
Priority	Priority	Select	High / Medium / Low
Assignee	Assignee	User	Must be active Jira user
Reporter	Reporter	User	Defaults to import user
Story Points	Story Points (custom)	Number	Numeric only
Sprint	Sprint	Sprint	Must match sprint name
Labels	Labels	Multi-text	Comma-separated
Due Date	Due Date	Date	YYYY-MM-DD format
Description	Description	Text Area	Supports wiki markup
Fix Version	Fix Version/s	Version	Must pre-exist in Jira
Components	Components	Component	Must pre-exist in project

Epic Link	Epic Link	Issue Link	Use Epic issue key
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Phase 3 — Validation Checklist

#	Validation Check	Method	Pass Criteria
1	No blank Summary fields	Formula check	0 empty rows
2	Issue Type values valid	VLOOKUP match	All match Jira types
3	Dates in correct format	Regex validation	YYYY-MM-DD pattern
4	Assignees exist in Jira	User API check	All users found
5	No duplicate issue keys	Unique count	No duplicates
6	Story points are numeric	Type check	INT or FLOAT only
7	Sprints exist in project	Sprint API check	All sprints found
8	File size under 10MB	File info	< 10,485,760 bytes
9	Character encoding UTF-8	Text editor	No mojibake chars
10	Epic links reference valid epics	Issue key check	All epics exist

Phase 4 — Common Errors & Resolutions

Error Message	Cause	Resolution
'Issue Type' not found	Typo or wrong value	Check project's issue type scheme
User not found	Wrong email/username	Invite user to Jira first
Sprint does not exist	Sprint name mismatch	Use exact sprint name from board
Required field missing	Blank mandatory column	Fill all required fields
Date parse error	Wrong date format	Use YYYY-MM-DD format
File too large	CSV over 10MB	Split into multiple files
Encoding error	Non-UTF-8 characters	Re-save as UTF-8 in Excel
Epic not found	Invalid epic key	Verify epic exists in project

Sample CSV Template

Use this template structure for your import file. The first row must be the header row exactly as shown:

Summary	Issue Type	Priority	Assignee	Story Points	Sprint	Labels
Setup auth service	Story	High	alice@co.com	5	Sprint 12	backend
Fix login null bug	Bug	Critical	bob@co.com	2	Sprint 12	bug,auth

Improve onboarding flow	Task	Medium	carol@co.com	3	Sprint 13	ux
API rate limiting	Story	High	alice@co.com	8	Sprint 13	api
Update API docs	Task	Low	dave@co.com	1	Sprint 12	docs

Migration Timeline & Deliverables

Day	Activity	Deliverable
Day 1	CSV audit & field mapping design	Field mapping document
Day 1	Validate CSV against Jira schema	Validation report
Day 2	Test import on staging environment	Test import results
Day 2	Fix errors & re-validate	Clean CSV file
Day 3	Production import execution	Import confirmation
Day 3	Post-import QA & issue verification	QA checklist sign-off